with Hayden, Ponting and Clarke all making hundreds, and the match ended in a draw – but only after Sehwag had added an impressive 151 in our second innings. We had not managed to level the series but we had won back credibility and respect.

The final verdict

Before bringing down the curtain on the controversial 'Monkeygate' saga, as it had been dubbed in the press, Justice John Hansen heard everybody's evidence in the appeal on 28 January 2008. I stated exactly what I had heard and seen and also said that I had taken exception to us being labelled 'liars' by the match referee, Mike Procter, who had mentioned in his statement that 'I believe one group is telling the truth'. That he banned Bhajji for three Test matches seemed to us to show which group, in his opinion, was lying. It is never a pleasant thing to be called a liar and I was extremely angry.

In the end justice prevailed. The verdict of the appeal was that there was no evidence to suggest the use of a racist remark by Bhajji and the ban was lifted. Instead Bhajji was fined half of his match fee for using abusive language against Symonds. Bhajji could finally breathe a sigh of relief and we as a team felt vindicated.

India in Bangladesh 2007

1st Test. Chittagong. 18–22 May 2007

India 387–8 dec (**SR Tendulkar 101**, SC Ganguly 100, R Dravid 61, KD Karthik 56; M Mortaza 4–97, S Hossain 3–76) and 100–6 dec (**SR Tendulkar 31**; M Rafique 3–27, S Hossain 2–30)

Bangladesh 238 (M Mortaza 79, R Saleh 41; RP Singh 3–45, VRV Singh 3–48, **SR Tendulkar 1–15**) and 104–2 (J Omar 52*, H Bashar 37)

Match drawn

2nd Test. Dhaka. 25–27 May 2007

India 610–3 dec (W Jaffer 138, KD Karthik 129, R Dravid 129, **SR Tendulkar 122***, MS Dhoni 51*; M Rafique 2–181)

Bangladesh 118 (Shakib-Al-Hasan 30; Z Khan 5–34, A Kumble 3–32) and 253 (f/o) (M Mortaza 70, M Ashraful 67; RR Powar 3–33, **SR Tendulkar 2–35**)

India won by an innings and 239 runs